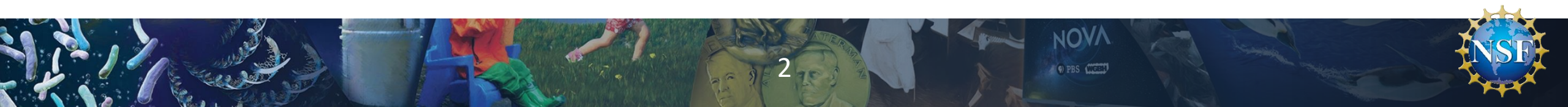




Almadena Chtchelkanova,
NSF CAREER Coordinating Committee
May 11, 2026

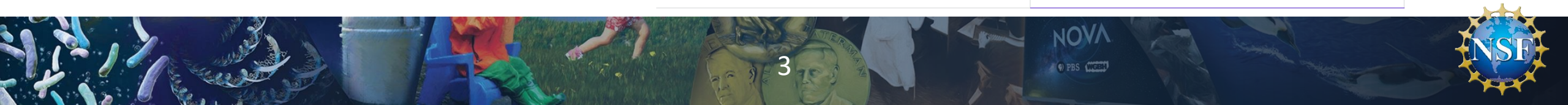
NSF CISE CAREER Programs

- NSF CER - Computing Education Research
- NSF FET - Foundations of Emerging Technology
- NSF AF - Algorithmic Foundations
- NSF CIF - Communications & Info. Foundations
- NSF SHF - Software & Hardware Foundation
- NSF FRR - Foundational Research in Robotics
- NSF III – Information, Integration & Informatics
- NSF HCC - Human-Centered Computing
- NSF RI - Robust Intelligence
- NSF CSR - Computer Systems Research
- NSF NeTS - Networking Technology and Systems
- NSF CPS - Cyber-Physical Systems
- NSF SaTC - Secure & Trustworthy Cyberspace



Program Contacts

Name	Email
NSF AF Program Team	cise-af@nsf.gov
NSF CIF Program Team	cise-cif@nsf.gov
NSF CSR Program Team	cise-csr@nsf.gov
NSF CER Program Team	cise-cer@nsf.gov
NSF CPS Program Team	cise-cps@nsf.gov
NSF FET Program Team	cise-fet@nsf.gov
NSF FRR Program Team	robotics@nsf.gov
NSF HCC Program Team	cise-hcc@nsf.gov
NSF III Program Team	cise-iii@nsf.gov
NSF NeTS Program Team	cise-nets@nsf.gov
NSF RI Program Team	cise-ri@nsf.gov
NSF SaTC Program Team	satc@nsf.gov
NSF SHF Program Team	cise-shf@nsf.gov



NSF Faculty Early Career Development (NSF CAREER) Program (NSF 22-586): Goals

- “A foundation-wide activity that offers the U.S. National Science Foundation’s most prestigious awards in support of early-career faculty who have the potential to serve as **academic role models in research and education and to lead advances in the mission of their department or organization.**”
- “Activities pursued by early-career faculty should build a firm foundation for a **lifetime of leadership in integrating education and research.**”



NSF Faculty Early Career Development (NSF CAREER) Program (NSF 22-586)

- **Review the solicitation** [NSF 22-586](#) and [NSF 22-100 FAQs](#) before preparing the proposal.
- **Project duration:** 5 years.
- **Proposals must comply** with the current [NSF Proposal and Award Policies & Procedures Guide \(PAPPG 24-1\)](#) and the latest program supplement [NSF 26-200](#).
- **Eligibility** is determined based on the applicant's status as of the submission date.
- **Proposal deadline:** Fourth Wednesday in July (July 22, 2026, 5:00pm local time this year).



NSF Faculty Early Career Development (NSF CAREER) Program (NSF 22-586)—Submission

- Proposals must be submitted through **Research.gov** or **Grants.gov**
- Research.gov is recommended for its built-in proposal compliance checks.
- If submitting through Grants.gov, allow additional time for processing before the deadline.



Principal Investigator Eligibility Criteria

- Must hold a **doctoral degree by proposal deadline.**
- Must be **untenured and employed** in an **at least a 50% tenure-track (or tenure-track-equivalent) assistant professor (or equivalent title)** position at an eligible institution as of the annual deadline.
- Must have **research and educational responsibilities** at an eligible institution.
- Must **not have previously received an NSF CAREER award.**
- Must **not have had more than two prior NSF CAREER proposals reviewed.**
- **Eligibility must be certified in Departmental Letter.**



Investigator Eligibility Criteria — Non-tenure

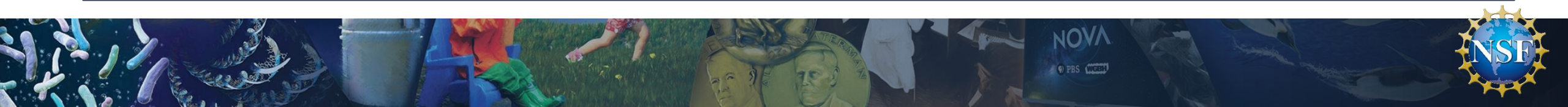
- Non-tenure track faculty can be eligible if the following are true:
 - Appointment is expected to last the full 5-year NSF CAREER award period.
 - Appointment must include substantial research and educational goals.
 - Early career equivalent to pre-tenure.
 - All other NSF CAREER eligibility requirements also apply
 - Eligibility certified in the Departmental Letter.
 - “Expected to last” does not mean “guaranteed to last” so no institution guarantees full employment with this letter.
- **Adjunct faculty are not eligible.**



Departmental Letter (2 pages max)

- Statement indicating the PI's eligibility for the NSF CAREER program as of submission date.
- Description of how the PI's career goals and responsibilities align with the department and institution.
- Commitment to the PI's proposed NSF CAREER research and education activities.
- Description of departmental support of the professional development of the PI to further the PI's efforts to integrate research and education.

Note: The Departmental letter is not a letter of support but should address these items above.



NSF CAREER Personnel and Budgets

- Co-PIs on cover sheet are not allowed.
- Request for support of other senior personnel, consultants, or sub-awards is allowed, commensurate with a limited role in the project.
- International activities are encouraged and may be supported by the NSF Office of International Science and Engineering (NSF OISE).
- Programs may support buy-out of academic year time for teaching-intensive institutions (check with your program director).
- Programs may or may not prefer to make awards with budget close to the anticipated minimum size (check with your program director).



Unfunded Collaborators

- Follow PAPPG 24-1 requirements – Chapter II.C.2.d(iv)
- Substantial collaborations not included in the budget should:
 - Be described in the Facilities, Equipment and Other Resources section of the proposal (see Chapter II.C.2.i)
 - Include a letter of collaboration from each collaborator.
- Letters should be included in Supplementary Documentation (Research.gov) and follow the format specified in Chapter II.C.2.j.
- Collaborative activities identified in the budget should follow the instructions in Chapter II.D.3.
- Unfunded collaborators like senior personnel should have a limited role in the project's intellectual merit and broader impact.



NSF CAREER Varies Across NSF

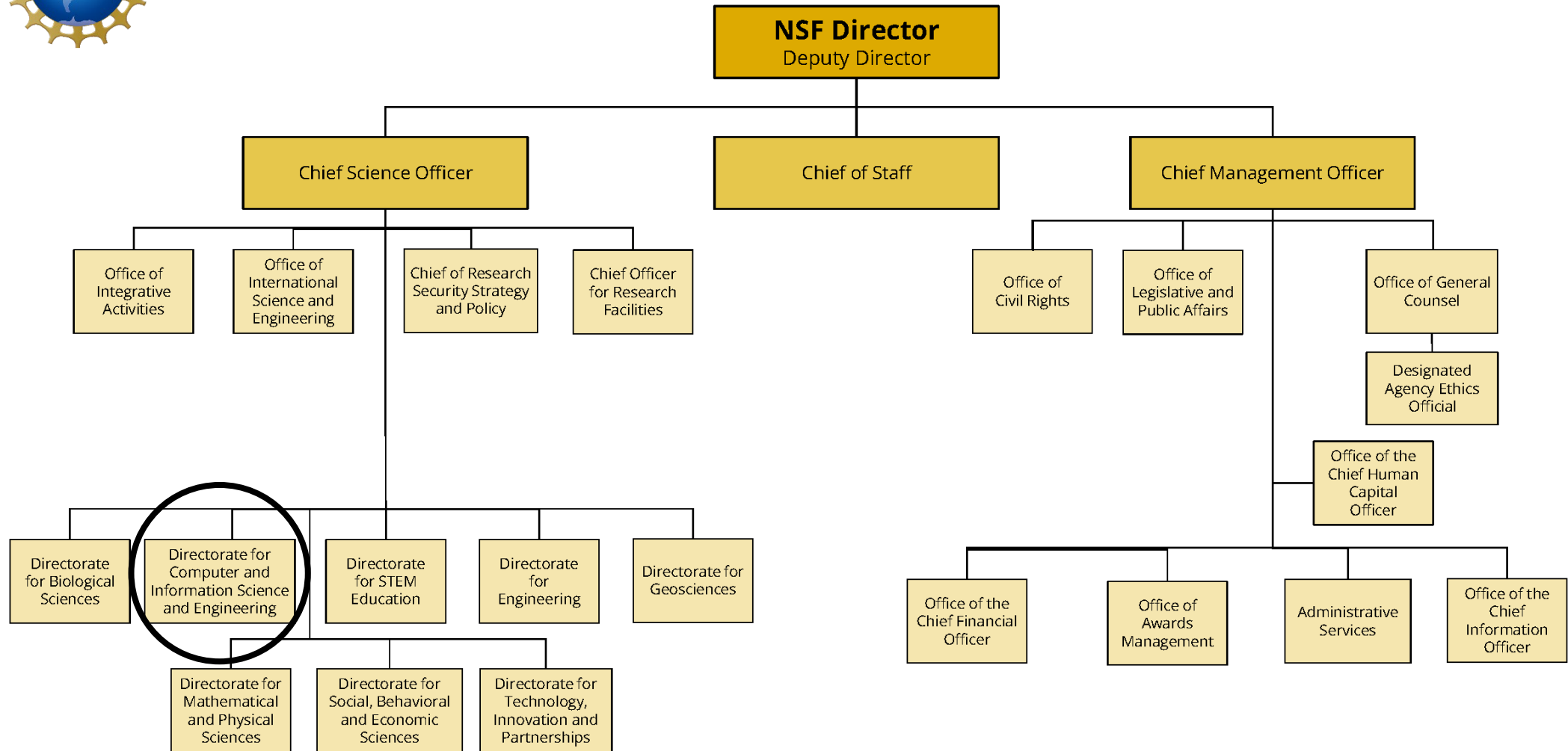
- NSF CAREER proposals are submitted to, and reviewed by, one or more NSF research programs.
- Award sizes vary by each NSF directorate, division or program.
- Contact relevant program directors to discuss ideas and program fit.
- If unsure which program fits, consult NSF CAREER contacts:
<http://www.nsf.gov/crssprgm/career/contacts.jsp>
- For interdisciplinary proposals, contact all relevant programs or NSF CAREER program contacts.





U.S. National Science Foundation

12/14/2025 organizational structure



Merit Review of NSF CAREER Varies Across NSF

- Ad hoc & Panel (review with other proposals under consideration by the disciplinary program):
 - most of GEO (AGS uses ad hoc only)
 - BIO and SBE
- **Primarily dedicated CAREER Panels :**
 - **ENG, CISE, EDU**
- MPS varies by Division:
 - AST : Panel only
 - CHE, DMR – Mix of ad hoc & panels
 - DMS – Mostly panel
 - PHY – Mostly ad hoc



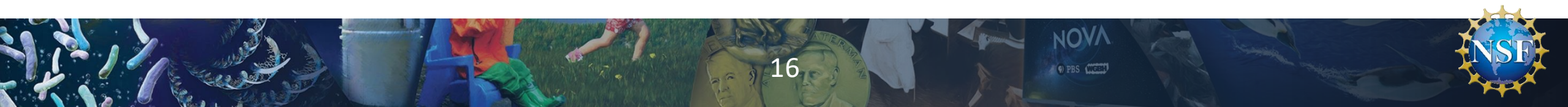
NSF CAREER Proposal Criteria

- Evaluated using NSF's two merit review criteria:
 - What is the intellectual merit of the proposed activity?
 - What are the broader impacts of the proposed activity?
- Additional Consideration for NSF CAREER proposals:
 - Integration of research and education.



NSF CAREER Proposal Review Considerations

- The **Intellectual Merit** is the potential that your research has to advance the knowledge base of the field of science or engineering.
- The **Broader Impacts** focus on the potential benefit to society and achievement of desired societal outcomes.
- The **Integration of Research and Education** describes the reciprocal relationship between the proposed research and education activities and how they may inform each other in their career development as both outstanding researchers and educators.



Intellectual Merit



Importance of proposed activity:

Should this be done?

- to advance knowledge and understanding
- within the field and across fields
- creative, original, or potentially transformative research
- significance of expected contributions

How well conceived and organized is the proposed activity?

Can this be done?

- Soundness and feasibility of approach, evaluation, research plan
- How qualified is the team to conduct the proposed research
- Data Management Plan
- Mentoring Plan
- Access to necessary resources, equipment, facilities, etc.
- Requested support (budget)



Intellectual Merit, cont.

Encompasses the potential to advance knowledge

Considerations

1. What is the potential for the proposed activity to advance knowledge and understanding within its own field or across different fields
2. To what extent do the proposed activities suggest and explore creative, original, or potentially transformative concepts?
3. Is the plan for carrying out the proposed activities well-reasoned, well-organized, and based on a sound rationale? Does the plan incorporate a mechanism to assess success?
4. How well qualified is the individual, team, or organization to conduct the proposed activities?
5. Are there adequate resources available to the PI (either at the home organization or through collaborations) to carry out the proposed activities?



Broader Impacts



Accomplished through

- The research itself
- Activities that are directly related to specific research projects, AND/OR
- Activities that are supported by, but complementary to the project.

Considerations

1. What is the potential for the proposed activity to benefit society or advance desired societal outcomes?
2. To what extent do the proposed activities suggest and explore creative, original or potentially transformative concepts?
3. Is the plan for carrying out the proposed activities well-reasoned, well-organized and based on sound rationale? Does the plan incorporate a mechanism to assess success?
4. How well qualified is the individual, team or institution to conduct the proposed activities?
5. Are there adequate resources available to the principal investigator (either at the home institution or through collaborations) to carry out the proposed activities?

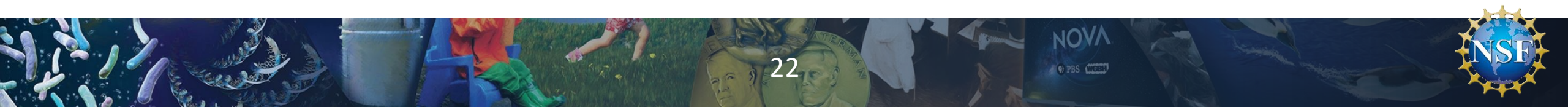
Integration of Research and Education

- All NSF CAREER proposals must have an integrated research and education plan.
- NSF recognizes that there is no single approach to an integrated research and education plan; but encourages all applicants to think creatively about how their research will impact their education goals and, conversely, how their education activities will feed back into their research.
- These plans should reflect the proposer's own disciplinary and educational interests and goals, as well as the needs and context of his or her organization.
- Because there may be different expectations within different disciplinary fields and/or different organizations, a wide range of research and education activities may be appropriate for the CAREER program



Integration of Research and Education, cont.

- Think creatively about the reciprocal relationship between research and education activities and how they may inform each other in your career development.
- Plans should reflect your disciplinary and educational interests and goals, as well as the needs and context of your organization.
- There are different expectations within different disciplinary fields – a wide range of research and education activities may be appropriate for the NSF CAREER program
- Some investigators may wish to pursue an additional activity such as entrepreneurship, industry partnerships, or policy that enhances their research and education plans
- See the NSF CAREER program solicitation for thought-provoking examples
- Communicate with NSF CAREER contact(s) discuss expectations.



Data Management and Sharing Plan

- Two-page required supplementary document (PAPPG, Chapter II.D.2.i.(ii))
- Must be reviewed as part of the proposal (under IM, BI or both as appropriate)
- May Include:
 - the types of data, samples, physical collections, software, curriculum materials, and other materials to be produced in the course of the project*;
 - the standards to be used for data and metadata format and content (where existing standards are absent or deemed inadequate, this should be documented along with any proposed solutions or remedies);
 - policies for access and sharing including provisions for appropriate protection of privacy, confidentiality, security, intellectual property, or other rights or requirements;
 - policies and provisions for re-use, re-distribution, and the production of derivatives; and
 - plans for archiving data, samples, and other research products, and for preservation of access to them.
- If none of these materials are produced as apart of the project, PIs must provide a justification for not including a Data Management and Sharing Plan
 - See: <https://new.nsf.gov/funding/data-management-plan> for a full explanation
- NSF encourages consideration for how the project will share its data publicly with the research community (e.g. Open source datasets, etc.) and the impact of publicly shared datasets from a researchers' prior funded efforts.

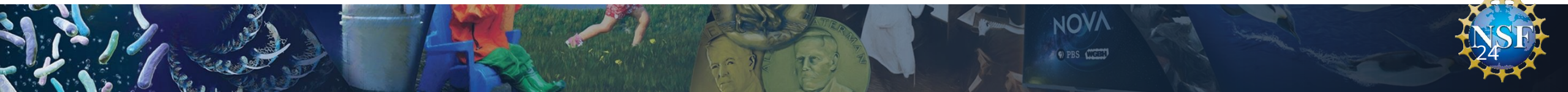


Mentoring Plan

- One-page supplementary document (PAPPG, [Chapter II – D.2.i\(i\)](#))
- Required if graduate student and/or postdoc salary or stipend is in the project budget
 - May be found in Budget under either
 - B. Other Personnel
 - F. Participant Support Costs
- Describes the mentoring that will be provided
- Reviewed under the Broader Impacts criterion



Familiarity varies among PIs and institutions
BUT this is an opportunity to foster best practices



Finding a Research Home

- Your research objectives and the knowledge gained immediately from the proposed work determines the NSF program fit, not the application of your research results.
- Be prepared to answer the question: “What is your research objective?” to help form your topic area
 - One-page summary (preferred)
- Check out the NSF CAREER program contacts’ page:

<https://www.nsf.gov/crssprgm/career/contacts.jsp>



The Next Step: You Submit to a Program

- Access the NSF web site: <http://www.nsf.gov/awardsearch> and www.nsf.gov/funding
 - Search for keywords
 - Check out research programs
 - Read what research topics they support
 - Read abstracts for recent awards
 - [Workshop reports](#)
- Not sure who to contact with an idea? Check out the section and directorate NSF CAREER Contacts:
<https://www.nsf.gov/crssprgm/career/contacts.jsp>



Award Data and Abstracts

Award Details



- [Search Awards](#)
- [Recent Awards](#)
- [Presidential and Honorary Awards](#)
- [About Awards](#)
- [How to Manage Your Award](#)
- [Grant General Conditions](#)
- [Cooperative Agreement Conditions](#)
- [Special Conditions](#)
- [Policy Office Website](#)

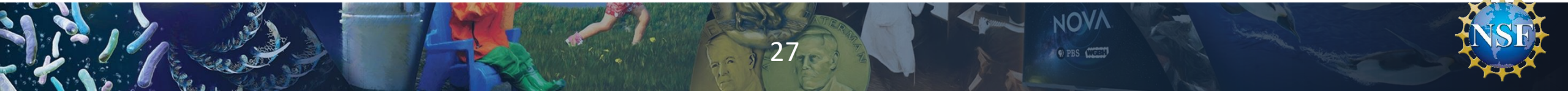
Award Abstract # 1555079
CAREER: Biologically inspired neural network models for robust speech processing

NSF Org:	IIS Division of Information & Intelligent Systems
Recipient:	THE TRUSTEES OF COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY IN THE CITY OF NEW YORK
Initial Amendment Date:	June 6, 2016
Latest Amendment Date:	July 22, 2020
Award Number:	1555079
Award Instrument:	Continuing Grant
Program Manager:	Kenneth Whang IIS Division of Information & Intelligent Systems CSE Directorate for Computer and Information Science and Engineering
Start Date:	June 1, 2016
End Date:	May 31, 2021 (Estimated)
Total Intended Award Amount:	\$502,210.00
Total Awarded Amount to Date:	\$502,210.00
Funds Obligated to Date:	FY 2016 = \$94,594.00 FY 2017 = \$97,431.00 FY 2018 = \$100,354.00 FY 2019 = \$180,641.00 FY 2020 = \$29,190.00

Skip to navigation t

History of Investigator:	Nima Mesgarani (Principal Investigator) nm2764@columbia.edu
Recipient Sponsored Research Office:	Columbia University 615 W 131ST ST NEW YORK NY US 10027-7922 (212)854-6851
Sponsor Congressional District:	13
Primary Place of Performance:	Columbia University New York NY US 10027-6902
Primary Place of Performance Congressional District:	13
Unique Entity Identifier (UEI):	F4N1QNPB95M4
Parent UEI:	
NSF Program(s):	Robust Intelligence
Primary Program Source:	01001617DB NSF RESEARCH & RELATED ACTIVIT 01001718DB NSF RESEARCH & RELATED ACTIVIT 01001819DB NSF RESEARCH & RELATED ACTIVIT 01001920DB NSF RESEARCH & RELATED ACTIVIT 01002021DB NSF RESEARCH & RELATED ACTIVIT
Program Reference Code(s):	1045, 7495, 8091
Program Element Code(s):	749500
Award Agency Code:	4900
Fund Agency Code:	4900
Assistance Listing Number(s):	47.070

Abstracts are found on this page below the award details



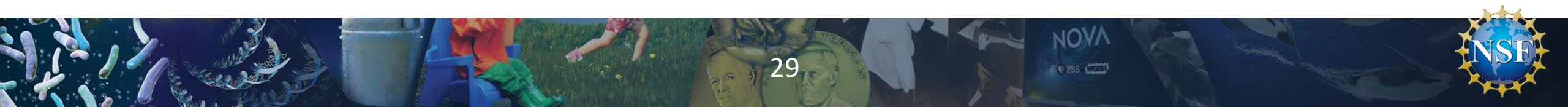
Interdisciplinary Projects – Choosing a Primary Program

- Reassess project scope. Can it be tuned/scaled back so key innovation lies within one program description?
- Email all relevant programs once to request program fit feedback.
- Consider program officer feedback carefully. That is what reviewers are looking for in that program.
- Revise the proposal to align with the best-fit program.
- You may list a secondary program, but NSF CAREER proposals are submitted to only one program.



NSF CAREER Proposal Elements

- **Integrated research and education plan.**
- Clear **synergy between research and education activities.**
- **Departmental Letter** confirming eligibility and career development support of the investigator.
- **Letters of Collaboration** (not letters of support or endorsement) when appropriate.
- **Budget aligned with project scope.**



What Reviewers Need to Understand

- What is the research objective?
- How will it be done? (the technical approach)
- Can the PI execute it? (you and your facilities)
- Why does it matter? (intellectual merit and broader impacts)
- How does it support the PI's career development? (integration of education and research)



Resource: Updates on NSF Priorities

- Visit NSF's website periodically to check for updates on priorities
 - <https://www.nsf.gov/updates-on-priorities>
- Subscribe to directorate newsletters
 - [NSF CISE directorate newsletter signup](#)



Serve as an NSF Proposal Reviewer

- Important service to your community.
- Offers insights into how the review process works.
- Helps you understand what makes a proposal compelling.
- Email the program alias aligned with your expertise.
- Include a 2-page NSF biosketch and keywords describing your expertise.



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Summary of Resources

- Current Solicitation [NSF 22-586](#)
- NSF CAREER Program FAQs ([NSF 22-100 FAQs](#))
- Review previous [webinars and workshops](#)
- Search keywords <http://www.nsf.gov/awardsearch>
- NSF Priorities <https://www.nsf.gov/updates-on-priorities>
- NSF CAREER program contacts
<https://www.nsf.gov/crssprgm/career/contacts.jsp>
- NSF CISE directorate [newsletter signup](#)
- NSF News [email signup](#)

